Measurement: Homework 2

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1 Child Mortality in Côte d'Ivoire (6 points)

1. Sampling (1 points)

(a) How should you transform pweight to obtain a weight that allows you to estimate statistics on the population of women in Cote d'Ivoire? Explain your computations.

I can use the pweight column to balance the class distribution of the sample to match the population distribution. The `pweight` column contains sample weights that modify the contribution of each observation to the overall statistics. It works as a frequency multiplier, where each observation is counted as if it were `pweight` number of observations. In practice, R can use the pweight column to compute weighted statistics, such as means and proportions by using the `weights` argument in functions like `lm()` or `survey::svydesign()`. Internally, weighted functions such as weighted means and lm will multiply each observation by its corresponding weight. For example a weighted mean will be computed using equation Equation 1, and weighted linear regression will minimize the weighted sum of squared residuals, as shown in equation Equation 2.

$$\bar{x}_w = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n} w_i x_i}{\sum_{i=1}^{n} w_i} \tag{1}$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} w_i (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2 \tag{2}$$

2. Measurement of under 5 mortality rate (5 points)

(a) What method can be deemed preferable and why? Give the pros and cons of both methods.

The preferable method is method 2 (M2) because method 1 (M1) underestimates the mortality rate by not capturing the deaths that occur after the survey period. Figure 1 shows graphycally the surveyed groups: the x-axis represents the age of the child at the time of the survey, and the y-axis represents the age of the child at the time of death. The red arrow at 45 degrees indicates the frontier of possible outcomes, since by definition noone can die after their current age, the survey caputures outcomes below the frontier. Notice M1 captures area B and drops area C underestimating the true mortality rate. M2 captures area C which represents the true mortality rate. For example a surveyed mother has a child one year before the survey and the child dies the year after the survey (area C in Figure 1), M1 will not capture his death because by definition nothing can die after its current age.

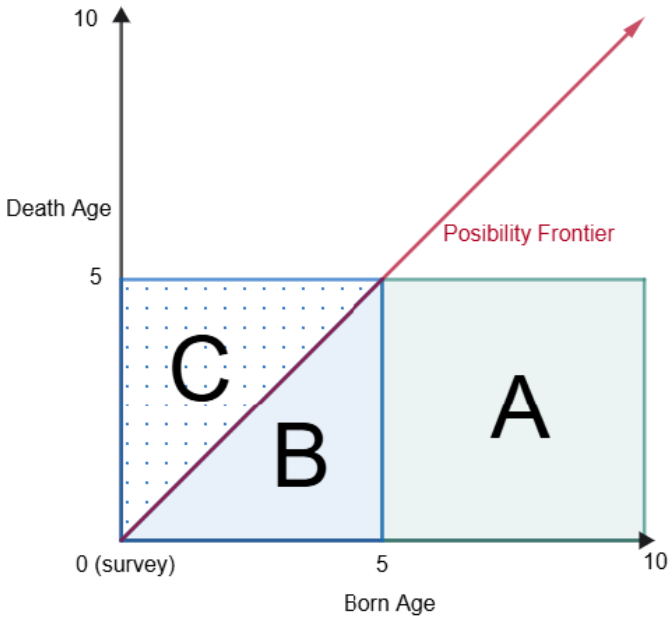
M1

- Pros: it is easy to compute, captures the most recent deaths (recency).
- Cons: underestimates the mortality rate, downward biased, does not capture deaths after the survey period.

M2

- Pros: provides a robust estimate of the true mortality rate.
- Cons: it requires a longer period of time to capture deaths, less recent than M1.

Figure 1: Mortality estimator analysis



(b) Child mortality rates in Côte d'Ivoire.

i. Compute mortality rates with both methods for boys and girls separately (don't forget the weights).

Table 1: Child mortality rates in Côte d'Ivoire, by sex and method.

	M1 (Boys)	M2 (Boys)	Diff (Boys)	M1 (Girls)	M2 (Girls)	Diff (Girls)	Diff M2 G-B
Mortality rate	0.117 ***	0.135 ***	0.017	0.084 ***	0.115 ***	0.031 ***	-0.020 *
	(0.007)	(0.008)	(0.011)	(0.007)	(0.008)	(0.010)	(0.011)
N	1431	1332		1428	1291		
R2	0.000	0.000		0.000	0.000		

Significance: *** p < 0.01; ** p < 0.05; * p < 0.1

ii. Compare and comment.

Table 1 shows the estimated child mortality rates in Côte d'Ivoire for boys and girls using both methods and their differences. The results confirm our theory of M1 underestimating the true mortality rate. We can clearly see the method estimates differences are positive indicating that M1 systematically underestimates the true mortality rate estimated by M2. Using the best method (M2), the average mortality rate for boys is 13.5% and for girls is 11.9%. The difference between girls and boys is -2 percentage points and statitically significant at the 90% confidence level, indicating that boys have a higher mortality rate than girls.

2 Health status, nutritional status and wealth in Côte d'Ivoire (7 points)

Stunted children are defined as children showing a height stature that is lower than the median of the reference population by 2 standard deviations measured on the same reference population. That is children such as the z-score is lower than -2 ($z \leq -2$), where the z-score is given by the following formula:

$$Z = \frac{\text{height} - \text{WHOMedian}(\text{sex}, \text{age})}{\text{WHOstdev}(\text{sex}, \text{age})}$$

1. Weight Unit Correction

In 2008, the weight could be measured in either kilograms or hectograms. However, the unit was not systematically reported. It was therefore assumed that all the weights were reported in kilograms.

(a) Derive an expression for the sample mean weight in this context, and show that, if we knew just one parameter, we could obtain a non-biased estimate of the mean weight despite the hectogram issue. (.5 point)

Let's denote the estimated mean weight as W_{obs}, the true mean weight as W_{true}, and the proportion of weights measured in hectograms as p_h. The observed mean weight can be expressed as the sum of the mean weights measured in kg and in hectograms multiplied by their corresponding probabilities:

$$\begin{aligned} E[W_{\text{obs}}] &= (1 - p_h) \cdot W_{\text{true}} + p_h \cdot W_{\text{true}} \cdot 10 \\ &= W_{\text{true}} \cdot (1 - p_h + 10p_h) \\ &= W_{\text{true}} \cdot (1 + 9p_h) \end{aligned}$$

Thus, having an estimate of p_h would allow us to correct the observed mean weight. Notice that if $p_h = 0$, then $E[W_{\text{obs}}] = W_{\text{true}}$, and if $p_h = 1$, then $E[W_{\text{obs}}] = 10W_{\text{true}}$.

For applying the correction, it is necessary to have a good estimate of p_h. In this case, it can be approximated by the proportion of weights above 25kg in 2008 which is 30.4% of the observations. Using this, we can correct the mean weight estimate by dividing the observed mean weight by $(1+9p_h)$. See 2 where the 2008 mean weight is corrected. After correction, the mean weight in 2008 is 11.48kg, which is consistent with previous years.

Table 2: Summary of Weight Estimates With Hectogram Correction

Year	Obs	Mean Weight	Mean Weight Corrected
1988	6475	12.46	12.46
1993	7109	11.94	11.94
2008	7333	42.87	11.48

(b) Come up with an empirical criterion to identify hectogram mistakes, and a graphical way to show the 2008 weight distribution, before and after correcting for mistakes, compared with the 1988 and 1993 weight distributions. (1 point)

By looking at the original distribution the weight measurements in 2008 show a wider distribution than the 1988 and 1993 distributions. The 2008 distribution shows a principal component at around 12kg but also shows multiple peaks at weight $>$ 25kg while the 1988 and 1993 distributions show a principal component at around 12kg with minimal outliers e.g. a few values below 1kg. See Figure 2 LHS.

After updating the 2008 weight distribution by dividing all weights $>$ 25kg by 10, the distribution shows no peaks after 25kg. See Figure 2 RHS.

2. Z-Score Computation

Using the variables medheight and stdheight, compute each child's z-score. (.5 point) Estimated z-scores are computed using the mentioned formula. The resulting distribution of z-scores for 2-4 years old children by year and region is shown in Figure 3a.

Figure 2: Distribution of Weight (kg) Before and After Correction

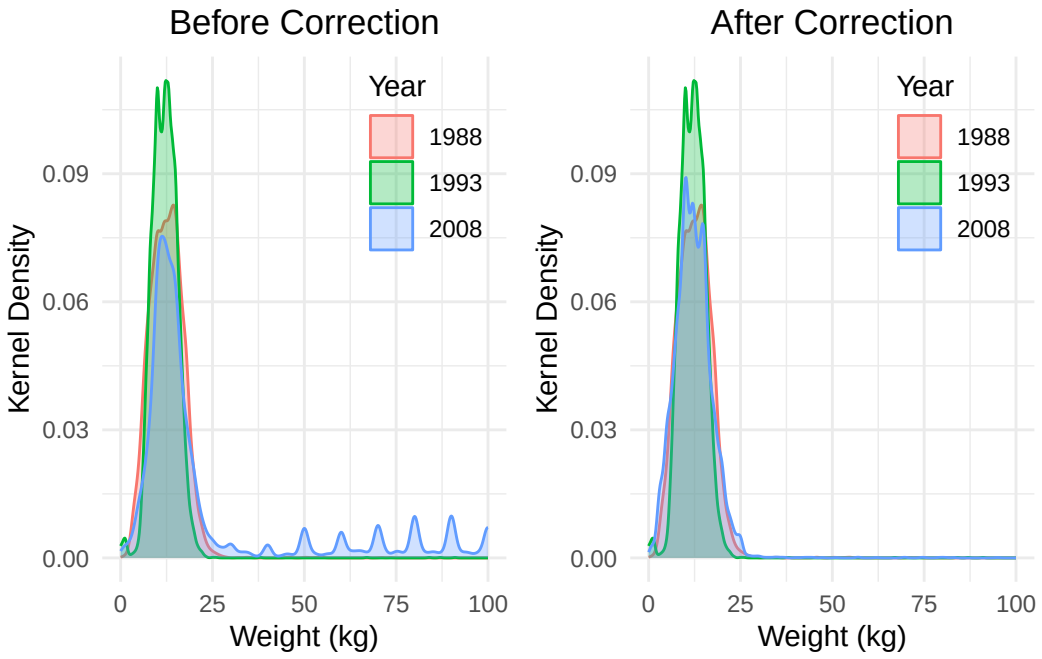
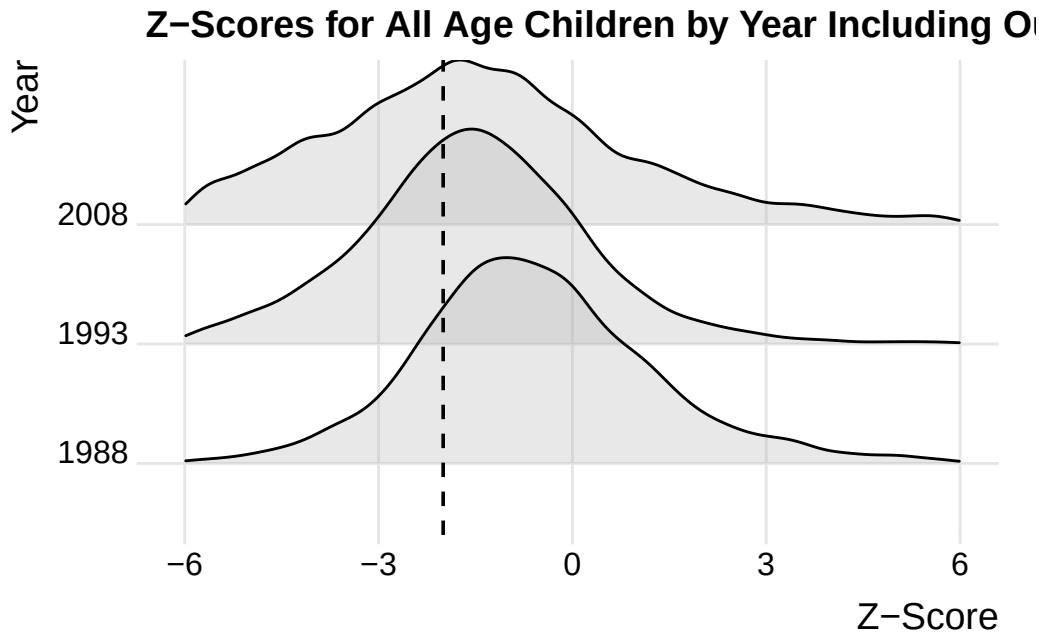


Figure 3: Distribution of z-scores by year

(a) X-axis is limited to -6 to 6, and the dashed line indicates the stunting threshold of -2.



3. Height Stature over time and across regions (3 points)

(a) Estimate the stunting rate for 2-4 years old children over time in the North, in the South, and at the national level. Decide what are outliers, and show results both including and excluding outliers. Comment your results, making all relevant comparisons.

As shown in Table 3, the national stunting rate for 2-4 years old children with outliers is 24.1% in 1988, 42% in 1993, and 46.4% in 2008. This increasing trend shows an overall increment of 22.3 percentage points in the stunting rate over the 20-year period.

The north and south regions an increasing trend overtime, but the north region shows a higher stunting rate than the south region in 1988 and 2008. Particularly, in 1988 the difference between north and south is 5.6 percentage points at the 1% significance level, and in 2008 the difference is 4.5 percentage points at the 5% significance level. In 1993 the difference is not statistically significant different frm zero, indicating that the north and south regions had similar stunting rates in 1993. Many theories can explain the differences between north and south e.g. differences in measurement, differences in the population, or the effect of socioeconomic factors such as poverty-alleviating programs, and access to health care.

The results excluding outliers show a similar trend in 1988 and 1993, however, in 2008 the stuting is not as different from 1933 except in the north region where there is a difference of 4 percentage points. This change in the pattern suggest that the outliers correction had an impact on the results and drafted conclusions. Regional differences between north and south persist, there are still a significant difference of 6.1 and 3.5 percentage points in 1988 and 2008 at the 1% and 10% significance levels respectively between the north and south regions despite the change in the stunting rate over time pattern.

The patterns validate the observations made in Figure 4a where the distribution of z-scores less than -2 is higher in the north region than in the south region in 1988 and 2008, while in 1993 the distributions are similar.

Table 3: National, North, and South stunting rates for 2-4 years old children excluding outliers.

	National	North	South	Diff (North-South)	National	North	South	Diff (North-South)
Year 1988	0.241 ***	0.282 ***	0.226 ***	0.056 ***	0.239 ***	0.284 ***	0.222 ***	0.061 ***
	(0.009)	(0.016)	(0.011)	(0.020)	(0.009)	(0.016)	(0.010)	(0.020)
Year 1993	0.420 ***	0.409 ***	0.423 ***	-0.014	0.412 ***	0.397 ***	0.416 ***	-0.020
	(0.007)	(0.014)	(0.008)	(0.017)	(0.007)	(0.014)	(0.008)	(0.017)
Year 2008	0.464 ***	0.498 ***	0.453 ***	0.045 **	0.410 ***	0.436 ***	0.402 ***	0.035 *
	(0.008)	(0.015)	(0.009)	(0.018)	(0.008)	(0.016)	(0.010)	(0.019)
Outliers	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
N	11755	3194	8561		10897	2930	7967	
R2	0.410	0.421	0.407		0.381	0.384	0.381	

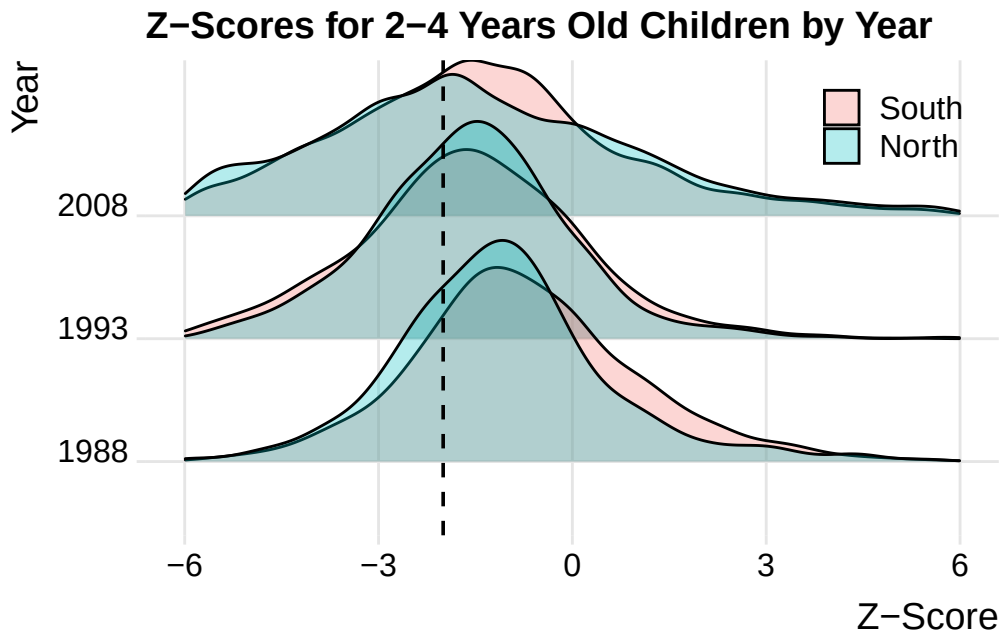
Significance: *** p < 0.01; ** p < 0.05; * p < 0.1

(b) Estimate the stunting rate for 2-4 years old children over time for boys and for girls at the national level. Decide what are outliers, and show results both including and excluding outliers. Comment your results, making all relevant comparisons.

As shown in Table 4, the stunting rate for boys and girls is increasing over time for the model with outliers (LHS four models). Starting from 1988, boys and girls had a stunting rate of 24.6% and 23.6% with no significant difference. In 1993, boys and girls had a stunting rate of 43% and 40% with a significant difference of 3 percentage points indicating boys had a higher stunting rate. In 2008, boys and girls had a stunting rate of 47% and 45% respectively with no significant difference.

Figure 4: Distribution of z-scores for 2-4 years old children by year and region

(a) X-axis is limited to -6 to 6, and the dashed line indicates the stunting threshold of -2.



The stunting rates pattern without outliers (RHS four columns) changes in 2008. In this period, removing the outliers lowered the national stunting rates from 47% with outliers to 41% without outliers. Differences between boys and girls are significant at 5% significance level in 1993, while there is no significant difference in 1988 and 2008.

Observations are confirmed by Figure 5a where the distribution of z-scores less than -2 is higher for boys than girls in 1993, while in 1988 and 2008 the distributions are similar.

Table 4: National, Male, and Female stunting rates for 2-4 years old children.

	National	Male	Female	Diff (Male-Female)	National	Male	Female	Diff (Male-Female)
Year 1988	0.241 ***	0.246 ***	0.236 ***	0.011	0.239 ***	0.245 ***	0.233 ***	0.011
	(0.009)	(0.012)	(0.013)	(0.018)	(0.009)	(0.012)	(0.013)	(0.018)
Year 1993	0.420 ***	0.434 ***	0.405 ***	0.029 **	0.412 ***	0.425 ***	0.398 ***	0.028 **
	(0.007)	(0.010)	(0.010)	(0.014)	(0.007)	(0.010)	(0.010)	(0.014)
Year 2008	0.464 ***	0.473 ***	0.453 ***	0.020	0.410 ***	0.420 ***	0.398 ***	0.022
	(0.008)	(0.010)	(0.011)	(0.015)	(0.008)	(0.011)	(0.012)	(0.016)
Outliers	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
N	11755	6072	5683		10897	5610	5287	
R2	0.410	0.421	0.398		0.381	0.392	0.369	

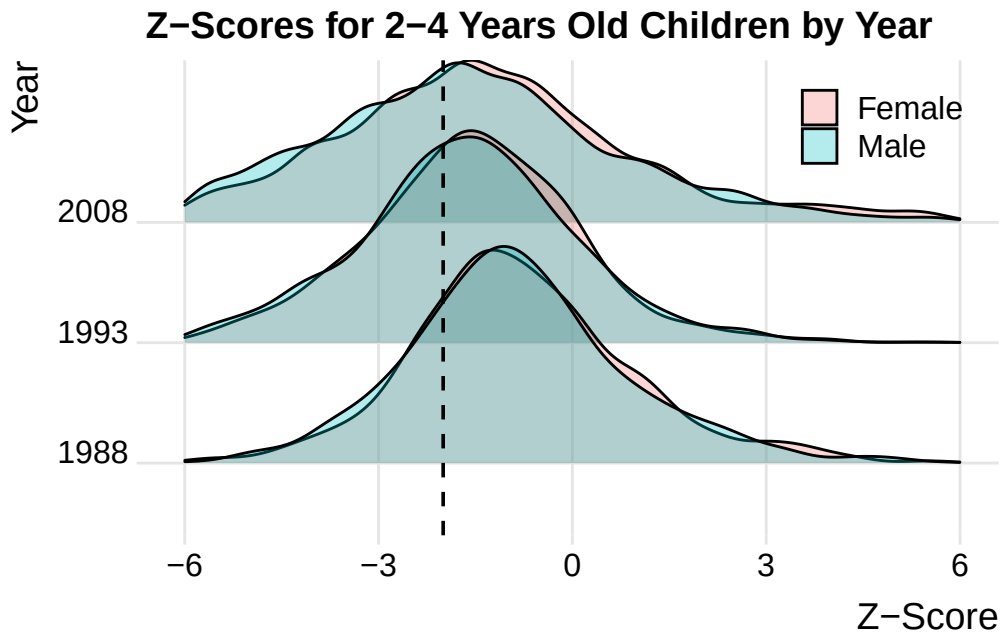
Significance: *** p < 0.01; ** p < 0.05; * p < 0.1

4. Height Stature and poverty (2 points)

Here, one would like to study how the gradient of the number of stunted children aged 2-4 years, and of household consumption per capita, as well as the relationship between the two, have

Figure 5: Distribution of z-scores for 2-4 years old children by year and region

(a) X-axis is limited to -6 to 6, and the dashed line indicates the stunting threshold of -2.



changed over time. Find a graphical or regression framework to represent this (many options are possible). Comment on your results and their limits.

Figure 6a represents the relationship between the log of household consumption per capita and the probability of being stunted for 2-4 years old children by year. The figure was created by binning the log of household consumption per capita into ventiles and calculating the weighted stunting rate for each ventile. Then a linear regression line was fitted to the binned data for each year.

Interpreting the results in Figure 6a, there is a clear trend increasing the stunting rate across years explained by the vertical shift of the regression lines. The slope of each regression line is negative, indicating that higher household consumption per capita is associated with a lower probability of being stunted. While the regression lines in 1988 and 2008 have similar slopes, the regression line in 1993 is steeper, indicating that the socioeconomic gradient of stunting was more pronounced in 1993 than in 1988 and 2008.

Analytically, the results can be confirmed through the linear regression model in Equation 3. Where $log(\tilde{\text{Conspc88}}_i)$ is the log of household consumption per capita centered around its mean, β_0 is the stunting rate for the mean child household consumption, and β_1 is the effect of log household consumption on the probability of being stunted in 1988. β_2 and β_3 capture the change in the stunting rate in 1993 and 2008 relative to 1988, while β_4 and β_5 capture the change in the effect of log household consumption on the probability of being stunted in 1993 and 2008 relative to 1988. Z_i is a vector of control variables including sex, age, and education of the household head. The results for all population and for each tercile are summarized in Table 5.

$$\begin{aligned} Stunted_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 log(\tilde{\text{Conspc88}}_i) + \beta_2 Y93_i + \beta_3 Y08_i + \\ (\beta_4 Y93_i \times log(\tilde{\text{Conspc88}}_i)) + \beta_5 (Y08_i \times log(\tilde{\text{Conspc88}}_i)) + Z_i + \epsilon_i \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

$$\text{where } \tilde{\text{Conspc88}}_i = log(\text{Conspc88}_i) - \overline{log(\text{Conspc88})}$$

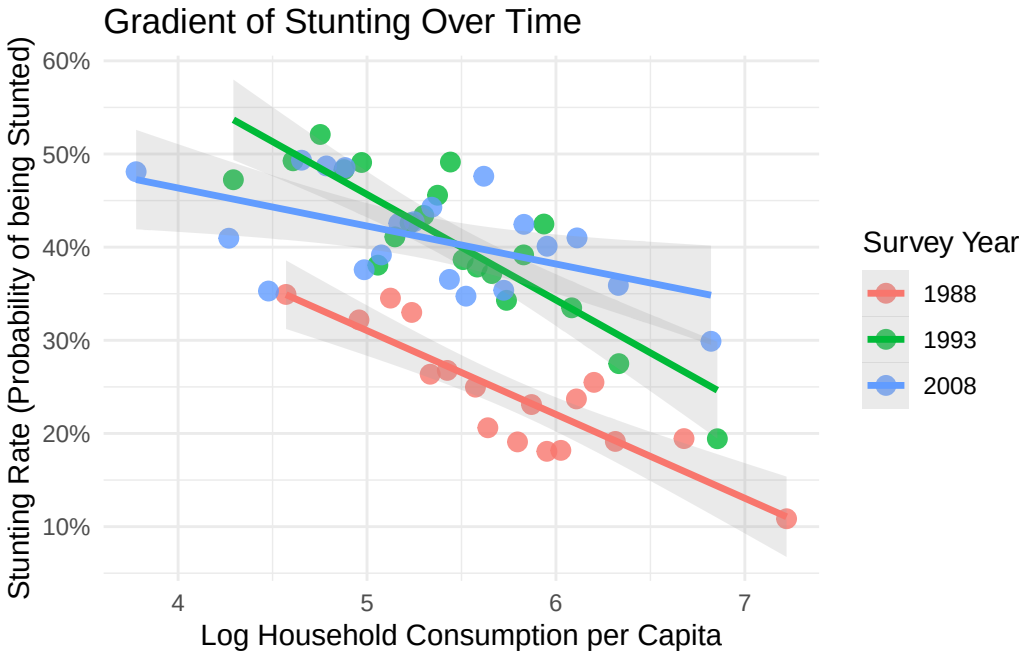
According to Table 5, the overall stunting rate for the average child in 1988 is 37%, an increment of 1% in consumption per capita is associated with a 0.07 percentage point decrease in the probability of being stunted. In following periods, the stunting rate was 13 and 15 percentage points higher in 1993 and 2008 respectively.

While the effect of consumption per capita on the probability of being stunted was not significantly different in 1988, in 2008 a 1% increase in consumption per capita was associated with a 0.04 percentage point more in the probability of being stunted relative to 1988.

The consumption terciles show a distinct pattern over time than the general population. In 1988, the stunting rate for low consumption children was 42% while the high consumption was 33%, a difference of 9 percentage points. In 1993, the stunting rate for medium and high consumption households was 15 and 21 percentage points higher than in 1988 for medium and high consumption households respectively, while the stunting rate for low consumption households was not significantly different from 1988. The change in the effect of consumption per capita on the probability of being stunted relative to 1988 was significantly different from zero for the high consumption tercile, indicating that the socioeconomic gradient of stunting was more pronounced in 1993 than in 1988 for high consumption households. In 1993, a 1% increase in consumption per capita was associated with a 0.12 percentage point decrease in the probability of being stunted relative to 1988 for high consumption households. In 2008 this difference was 0.08 percentage points for high consumption households and significant at the 10% level only.

Figure 6: Log household consumption ventiles vs stunting rate for 2-4 years old children by year

(a) Outliers are removed from the analysis. Includes linear regression lines with 95% confidence intervals.



3 A meaningful table (6 pts)

Construct a small statistical table showing a meaningful and policy relevant social fact about migration in the world. You may focus, or not, on a given region or country of origin, or on a particular subgroup of the population (children, etc.) A combination of originality, policy relevance and statistical accuracy will be very much appreciated. The table should fit in the top half of a page. It should have the attributes of a proper research-paper table: title, notes, etc. Table notes should indicate the source of data, the coverage (countries and population), the definition and units of variables and any other kind of information that is needed to read and understand the table. The bottom half of the page should be dedicated to a brief text, commenting upon the social fact that the table reveals.

[Your table and text here]

Table 5: Heterogeneous Effects of Consumption on Stunting Rates by Income Tertile

	General (All)	Low Income (T1)	Medium Income (T2)	High Income (T3)
Average Stunting Rate (1988)	0.371 ***	0.421 ***	0.393 ***	0.333 ***
	(0.021)	(0.063)	(0.036)	(0.039)
Log Consumption (Centered)	-0.074 ***	0.026	-0.136	-0.009
	(0.014)	(0.083)	(0.101)	(0.027)
Year 1993 Shift	0.138 ***	0.031	0.156 ***	0.218 ***
	(0.012)	(0.062)	(0.019)	(0.034)
Year 2008 Shift	0.150 ***	0.061	0.158 ***	0.257 ***
	(0.013)	(0.062)	(0.023)	(0.038)
Cons. Effect Diff (1993)	-0.023	-0.124	-0.047	-0.121 ***
	(0.018)	(0.092)	(0.126)	(0.041)
Cons. Effect Diff (2008)	0.047 ***	-0.032	0.020	-0.081 *
	(0.018)	(0.088)	(0.141)	(0.045)
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Outliers Excluded	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	10897	3634	3631	3632
R2	0.043	0.009	0.032	0.053

Significance: *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Appendix: R Script

Please do not show your R script before every question, but put your entire R script at the end of the homework.